

Tab 23



Board of Education Report

[Return to
Order of Business](#)

File #: Res-011-23/24, Version: 1

Dr. McKenna - November as Homeless Youth Awareness Month (Res-011-23/24) (For Action November 14, 2023)

Whereas, Congress first declared November as National Homeless Youth Awareness Month in 2007;

Whereas, California passed a resolution recognizing November as California Runaway and Homeless Youth Prevention Month in 2023;

Whereas, November is a time to elevate the issue of youth homelessness and grow the commitment to prevent and end homelessness among young people in the United States;

Whereas, In 2022, an estimated 9,100 youth in Los Angeles County lacked a safe place to live;

Whereas, A disproportionate number of youth experiencing homelessness are members of historically underserved populations;

Whereas, Youth experiencing homelessness are often exposed to dangers, have an increased likelihood of substance abuse, early parenthood, and trafficking, and experience depression and posttraumatic stress disorder;

Whereas, Nearly 70 percent of Los Angeles Unified School District's homeless students were chronically absent during the 2021-22 school year;

Whereas, The District is developing programs such as iAttend to identify homeless students and provide them with needed resources;

Whereas, Research has shown that homeless youth are more likely to score lower on standardized tests, be placed in special education, repeat a grade, transfer schools, and drop out of school;

Whereas, The McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act ensures educational rights and protections for homeless youth;

Whereas, In compliance with the McKinney Vento Homeless Assistance Act, the District's Homeless Education Office was designed to provide assistance to homeless students and families and maximize access to educational, social, and enrichment programs to promote student achievement;

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes that homelessness is a serious problem for many students, families, and the City at large; and

Whereas, The Board recognizes the important role education can play in preventing and ending youth

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homelessness; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District declares November 2023 as Homeless Youth Awareness Month; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes the unique challenges of youth experiencing homelessness and commits to increasing awareness of the issues impacting these students and will continue to support and explore programs, partnerships, and legislation that combat homelessness and remove barriers to success for homeless youth.